

LEVEL 1 • TERM 4 • LESSON 9 • FOR PARENTS

9 The Problem-Solving Toolbox

WHAT WE DID

We opened the problem-solving toolbox. Your child met seven tools (strip, table, list, draw it, work backwards, find one first, steps), picked a tool that fits, solved the problem, and checked the answer a second way. Solving one problem two ways, with 3 times as many and a total, goes past the Primary 1 syllabus on purpose.

> **Pick the tool that fits. Then check it a second way.**

TRY AT HOME (5 MINUTES)

1. Give your child a short story problem. Ask: which tool fits? There is often more than one.
2. Ask your child to solve a problem with one tool, then check it with another.
3. Make up a shopping or sharing problem. Ask your child to pick a tool first.

When your child is stuck

Let your child look at the tool cards and wait 10 seconds before helping. Please do not name the tool: ask "What does the story give us?" instead. If the look-back page says "I am still stuck", photograph it and send it to our business WhatsApp (+65 9880 5962). Photos are kept 90 days after the program ends.

Words we used

- tool: a way to solve a problem
- strip: a drawn bar for each amount
- work backwards: start at the end and undo
- check: solve it a second way

Good questions

- Which tool did you pick, and why?
- What does the story give us?
- How could you check it a second way?

Have ready for next lesson

- Your Quest Log (4 pages) from Book 8, closed in an envelope
- A quest partner: a grown-up, or a brother or sister
- A favourite page from your year books, and plain paper

Next lesson

Next lesson: Inquirers' Showcase and Mi's Challenge Quest, the last lesson of the year. Your child plays the Quest as a game with a quest partner, then shares a favourite idea (a pass is always fine). Keep the Quest Log in Book 8 closed until the tutor says to open it. Book 8 not here? Tell us on the business WhatsApp and we will send a PDF. Online practice: your tutor will share the link. The recording has the tutor, the shared screen and any unmuted voice. Missed a lesson? Every lesson is recorded; your tutor will share a private link with enrolled families.